

Welcome to the new millennium where body mapping is done on each level and each generic drug is formulated to target the specific issue. Cut to the era of super specialization where full fledged multi-specialty tertiary care and referral hospital, modern infrastructure and comprehensive patient care system, state-of-the-art investigation facilities, sophisticated pharmacy system and family participation in patient management form the chain of health care.

The forerunners of the specialty hospitals were women and children hospitals; rehabilitation hospitals for the physically challenged, psychiatric hospitals, and deaddiction centers have existed before the term super specialty was used. The current trend started with centers for eye and ear and a small group of cancer hospitals, which are generally regarded as being at the forefront of cancer treatment."

The super specialty hospitals in the southern part of India have set the trend of micro level care facilitating preventive care and healing under supervision, all under same roof.

To name a few, Yashoda Superspeciality hospital in Andhra Pradesh, the Mallya hospital in Karnataka, Rajan Eye Care in Chennai and the Trichur heart hospital are all known for their pioneering efforts.

Down south, Dr Palanivelu, Director of GEM hospital, Coimbatore voices concern at the lack of awareness about life style diseases like diabetes or hypertension among the present generation, these being the catalyst for diseased mortality.

On a different note, Vikram hospital in Coimbatore has

been a trend setter for ENT related issues.

Established in 1972, by Dr.P.G.Viswanathan, Vikram Hospital and ENT Research Centre at Coimbatore, the main objective was to make the ENT treatment affordable through innovative diagnostics and research based treatment.

Today, Vikram Hospital and ENT Research Centre has emerged as one of the finest super-speciality hospitals in the world.

Dr.P.G.Viswanathan is among the surgeons who have performed the world's largest series of operations for deafness caused by otosclerosis. Among the path breaking introductions to India are the techniques of small-fenestra stapedotomy, minimally invasive cochlear implant surgery and the standardised results of gold and titanium prosthesis treatment to replace the hearing bones, this has worked for the patients who have come here as a last resort

Dr Aruna Vishwanathan and Dr Anjana Vishwanathan have completed fellowships in Cochlear implant, otology, voice alteration, endoscopic sinus and laser surgery from Switzerland, Germany, Austria, Denmark, France and USA, this gained expertise has enabled them to head innovative research areas on affordable indigenous cochlear implant, tinnitus and sinus disease.

Dr Aruna Vishwanathan says," we offer international level of treatment at affordable rates; this is a big draw for patients from India and also for the international patients" Our goal is 'hearing for all by 2020'

